

GAMING



DirectX

When the x86 architecture was first created, it wasn't made keeping in mind its now ubiquitous usage – gaming. Unlike consoles that have the same hardware specifications for each device, PC hardware is different. This presented an enormous problem while developing games. Along came DirectX from Microsoft that created a programming interface between the OS and the underlying hardware. When manufacturers came out with



components all they had to do was ensure that they gave a DirectX compatible driver. After this any I/O function written by the programmer for the component simply worked as required! In a way it transformed a sophisticated calculator into an entertainment device. The latest version of DirectX (11.1) features stereoscopic 3D.



Violence

We're not talking about cute little turtles toppling over and falling off the screen. We're talking about content that's the reason the ESRB put that black and white M (Mature) box on your latest gaming title. These days a game is no fun without chainsaws, disembowelment, blood, gore, shrapnel and body parts flying around. Hey don't judge us. There's inner peace to be found in mindless violence.



Artificial Intelligence

As absurd as it may sound, perhaps the single most important factor that gave rise to single player gaming as well as promoted multiplayer gaming was AI. Games are fun because of the illusion of intelligent gameplay that non-human players can sometimes exhibit. What started off as mere pattern based puppetry for CPU players soon tried to emulate tactical behaviour. Of course game AI still has a long way to go. We can experience quite disappointingly when Nightmare bots become easy frags. Yet when you still scoff, "look at that dumb bot", you have in a way acknowledged its human-ness, and in a small way AI has succeeded. But where AI fails multiplayer online gaming thrives. No AI can yet replicate the absolute randomness of a n00b on meth or the strategic brilliance of the Koreans. Taking a page out of this realm, the next revolution in AI may be to learn and teach itself based on these zillions of bits of game data created from online matches.

47 per cent

Of the games being played online are Puzzle/Board/GameShow/Trivia/Card.

11% are Persistent Multi-Player Universe games, 14% are Downloadable games such as Bejeweled, 16% are Action/Sports/Strategy/Role Play, and 12% are others



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